The 30-Day Beginner Workout Plan

No Gym. No Equipment. No Experience Needed.

Empire Rewards — Free Edition

INTRODUCTION

According to research published in the European Journal of Social Psychology, it takes an average of 66 days to form a new habit. Yet 73% of people who set fitness goals give up before reaching that milestone. The primary reasons are:

- Starting too aggressively
- Lacking structure
- Not tracking progress

This 30-day plan is designed around the science of habit formation. It starts with short, manageable workouts (15–20 minutes) and gradually increases intensity as your body adapts.

Every day is planned for you — no guesswork, no decision fatigue. You follow the calendar, track your progress, and build the exercise habit that sticks.

Every exercise is bodyweight-only. You need approximately 6x6 feet of floor space and a mat or towel. That's it.

Let's begin.

PART 1: HOW TO USE THIS PLAN

The Rules

1. Follow the calendar.
Don't skip ahead. Don't do two workouts in one day to "catch up." The progression is designed so your body adapts safely.

2. Rest days are mandatory.
Muscle grows during rest, not during workouts. The two rest days per week are part of the plan, not optional.

3. Track everything.
The worksheet at the end lets you log reps, time, and how you feel each day. Watching your numbers improve is the strongest motivation there is.

4. Don't aim for perfection.
Miss a day? Just pick up where you left off. Miss a week? Restart from that point — don't go back to day one.

5. Modify if needed.
Every exercise in this plan has a beginner modification. Use it. There is no shame in knee push-ups or half squats. Do them until you can do the full version.

What You'll Need

- **Space:** About 6x6 feet of clear floor
- **Mat or towel:** For floor exercises (planks, glute bridges, dead bugs)
- **Water bottle:** Sip throughout each workout
- **Timer:** Your phone works — set it for the intervals
- **The tracking worksheet:** Print it or use the digital version

That's it. No dumbbells, no resistance bands, no gym membership.

PART 2: THE 30-DAY WORKOUT CALENDAR

Week 1 — Foundation (15–20 min/day)

Day 1 — Full Body A

- 3 sets: 10 bodyweight squats
- 3 sets: 5 knee push-ups
- 3 sets: 10 walking lunges (each leg)
- 2 sets: 20-second plank hold

Day 2 — Walk 20 minutes
A brisk walk is a workout. Keep a conversational pace.

Day 3 — Core + Mobility

- 3 sets: 10 glute bridges
- 3 sets: 10 bird dogs (each side)
- 3 sets: 10 dead bugs (each side)
- 5-minute stretching routine

Day 4 — Full Body B

- 3 sets: 12 bodyweight squats
- 3 sets: 6 knee push-ups
- 3 sets: 12 walking lunges (each leg)
- 3 sets: 20-second plank hold

Day 5 — Rest / Stretch
Light stretching only. 10 minutes is enough.

Day 6 — Walk 25 minutes
Slightly longer than day 2.

Day 7 — Rest
Full rest. No workout.

Week 2 — Build (20–25 min/day)

Day 8 — Full Body A+

- 3 sets: 12 bodyweight squats
- 3 sets: 8 knee push-ups
- 3 sets: 12 walking lunges (each leg)
- 3 sets: 25-second plank hold

Day 9 — Walk 30 minutes

Day 10 — Core + Mobility

- 3 sets: 12 glute bridges
- 3 sets: 12 bird dogs (each side)
- 3 sets: 12 dead bugs (each side)
- 3 sets: 20-second side plank (each side)
- 5-minute stretching

Day 11 — Full Body B+

- 3 sets: 15 bodyweight squats
- 3 sets: 10 knee push-ups
- 3 sets: 15 walking lunges (each leg)
- 3 sets: 30-second plank hold

Day 12 — Rest / Stretch

Day 13 — Walk 30 minutes

Day 14 — Rest

Week 3 — Push (25–30 min/day)

Day 15 — Circuit A
Complete 3 rounds:

- 12 squats
- 8 knee push-ups
- 10 lunges (each leg)
- 30-second plank
  Rest 60 seconds between rounds.

Day 16 — Walk 30 minutes

Day 17 — Full Body C

- 3 sets: 15 squats
- 3 sets: 10 knee push-ups
- 3 sets: 15 lunges (each leg)
- 3 sets: 30-second plank
- 3 sets: 15 glute bridges

Day 18 — Core Focus
Complete 3 rounds:

- 12 dead bugs (each side)
- 12 bird dogs (each side)
- 20-second side plank (each side)
- 10 calf raises

Day 19 — Rest / Stretch

Day 20 — Circuit B
Complete 3 rounds:

- 15 squats
- 10 knee push-ups
- 12 lunges (each leg)
- 40-second plank
  Rest 60 seconds between rounds.

Day 21 — Rest

Week 4 — Peak (30–35 min/day)

Day 22 — Full Body A++

- 4 sets: 15 squats
- 4 sets: 10 knee push-ups (or full push-ups if you can)
- 4 sets: 15 lunges (each leg)
- 4 sets: 40-second plank

Day 23 — Walk 35 minutes

Day 24 — Circuit C
Complete 4 rounds:

- 15 squats
- 10 push-ups
- 12 lunges (each leg)
- 45-second plank
- 15 glute bridges

Rest 60 seconds between rounds.

Day 25 — Full Body B++

- 4 sets: 15 squats
- 4 sets: 12 knee push-ups
- 4 sets: 15 lunges (each leg)
- 4 sets: 45-second plank
- 4 sets: 15 glute bridges

Day 26 — Rest / Stretch

Day 27 — Final Challenge
Complete 5 rounds:

- 15 squats
- 10 push-ups
- 12 lunges (each leg)
- 45-second plank

Rest 60 seconds between rounds.

Day 28–30 — Celebrate + Rest

You did it. Take three full days off. Your body earned it.

PART 3: THE 8 CORE EXERCISES

Every workout is built from these eight exercises. Master the form before adding reps.

1. Bodyweight Squat

How to do it: Stand with feet shoulder-width apart. Lower your hips as if sitting in a chair. Keep your chest up and knees tracking over your toes. Push through your heels to stand.

Form cue: Go as low as you can without your lower back rounding. If your heels lift, widen your stance.

Beginner modification: Hold onto a doorframe or counter for balance. Lower only halfway.

2. Knee Push-Up (Modified)

How to do it: Hands under shoulders, knees on the floor. Lower your chest until your elbows reach 90 degrees. Push back up.

Form cue: Keep your body in a straight line from knees to head. Don't let your hips sag or rise.

Beginner modification: Wall push-ups (standing, hands on wall) if knee push-ups are too hard.

3. Walking Lunge

How to do it: Step forward with one leg, lowering your back knee until it nearly touches the ground. Push through your front heel to stand, then step forward with the other leg.

Form cue: Keep your torso upright. If you can't balance, do reverse lunges instead (step backward).

Beginner modification: Hold onto a wall with one hand for balance.

4. Plank Hold

How to do it: Forearms on the ground, elbows under shoulders. Body in a straight line from head to heels. Hold.

Form cue: Squeeze your glutes and abs. If your hips sag, drop to your knees — but keep your body straight.

Beginner modification: Forearm plank from knees. Same form, less load.

5. Glute Bridge

How to do it: Lie on your back, knees bent, feet flat on the floor. Push your hips toward the ceiling until your body forms a straight line from knees to shoulders.

Form cue: Squeeze your glutes at the top. Don't arch your lower back — the movement comes from your hips.

Beginner modification: Push with less force and hold the top position for only 1 second.

6. Bird Dog

How to do it: On hands and knees, extend your right arm forward and left leg back simultaneously. Hold for 2 seconds, return, switch sides.

Form cue: Keep your hips level. Don't rotate your torso — the movement is straight forward and back.

Beginner modification: Just extend the arm first, then progress to arm + leg.

7. Dead Bug

How to do it: Lie on your back, arms up, knees bent at 90 degrees. Lower your right arm and left leg toward the ground simultaneously, then return and switch.

Form cue: Keep your lower back pressed into the floor throughout. Slow and controlled beats fast and sloppy.

Beginner modification: Move only the legs, keep arms still.

8. Standing Calf Raise

How to do it: Stand with feet hip-width apart. Rise onto the balls of your feet, hold for 1 second, lower slowly.

Form cue: Use a wall for balance if needed. Slow, controlled reps build more than fast bouncing.

Beginner modification: Do them seated if balance is an issue.

PART 4: WARM-UP AND COOL-DOWN

5-Minute Warm-Up

Do this before every workout:

- **1 minute:** March in place
- **1 minute:** Arm circles (forward then backward)
- **1 minute:** Leg swings (front-to-back, both legs)
- **1 minute:** Hip circles
- **1 minute:** Bodyweight squats (slow, controlled)

5-Minute Cool-Down

Do this after every workout:

- **1 minute:** Standing quad stretch (30 sec each leg)
- **1 minute:** Standing hamstring stretch (30 sec each leg)
- **1 minute:** Chest and shoulder stretch
- **1 minute:** Child's pose
- **1 minute:** Deep breathing — in through nose, out through mouth

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PART 5: NUTRITION TIMING FOR BEGINNERS

You don't need a special diet to see results. But what you eat around your workouts makes a difference in how you feel and recover.

Before Your Workout (1–2 hours)

Eat a light meal with carbs + protein. Examples:

- Banana + peanut butter
- Oatmeal + protein
- Greek yogurt + berries
- Toast + eggs

Why: Fuels your workout without feeling sluggish.

During Your Workout

Water — sip throughout.

Why: Dehydration reduces performance and recovery.

After Your Workout (within 1 hour)

Protein + carbs. Examples:

- Chicken + rice
- Eggs + toast
- Protein shake + fruit
- Tuna + pasta

Why: Supports muscle repair and glycogen replenishment.

Rest Days

Normal balanced meals. Focus on protein and vegetables.

Why: Recovery happens on rest days, not workout days.

That's it. No calorie counting, no macro tracking, no restrictive diets. Just fuel your workouts and eat balanced meals the rest of the time.

PART 6: PROGRESS TRACKING

Print this worksheet and fill it in after every workout. Watching your numbers improve over 30 days is the strongest motivation there is.

Day Date Exercise Reps/Time Completed Energy (1–10) Notes

1

2

3

...

(The full printable worksheet is included in your download.)

What to Track

- **Reps completed** — how many you actually did
- **Time completed** — for planks and walks
- **Energy level** — 1 (exhausted) to 10 (great)
- **Notes** — anything that felt hard, easy, or different

What to Look For

- **Weeks 1–2:** You may feel sore. This is normal.
- **Week 2–3:** Movements start feeling natural. Reps get easier.
- **Week 3–4:** Visible progress. Clothes may fit differently.
- **End of 30 days:** You've completed 20 workouts and built a genuine habit.

PART 7: REST DAY RECOVERY GUIDE

Rest days are not lazy days. They're the days when your body repairs muscle tissue and rebuilds stronger.

What to Do on Rest Days

- **Light walking** — 15–20 minutes is perfect
- **Gentle stretching** — 10 minutes, focus on tight areas
- **Foam rolling** — 5 minutes per major muscle group (optional)
- **Hydration** — drink more water than usual
- **Sleep** — aim for 7–9 hours

What Not to Do

- **Don't do "extra" workouts** to make up for missed days
- **Don't do intense cardio** on rest days
- **Don't skip rest days** even if you feel great — the plan is designed this way on purpose

How Rest Builds Muscle

When you lift weights or do bodyweight exercises, you create tiny tears in your muscle fibers. During rest days, your body repairs those tears and makes the fibers slightly stronger. Skip the rest, and you skip the growth.

PART 8: HOW TO REPEAT THE PLAN

After 30 days, you can:

Option 1: Repeat with heavier load

Same exercises, higher reps. If you were doing 15 squats, do 20. If you were doing 45-second planks, do 60-second planks.

Option 2: Progress to harder variations

- Knee push-ups → Full push-ups
- Bodyweight squats → Jump squats
- Regular lunges → Jumping lunges
- Plank → Plank with leg lift

Option 3: Move to the intermediate plan

If you have our Home Workout Routines guide, the intermediate level is the natural next step.

Option 4: Maintain

Repeat the plan at the same intensity. Consistency beats intensity every time.

CONCLUSION

You now have everything you need:

- A 30-day workout calendar
- 8 core exercises with form cues
- A warm-up and cool-down routine
- Beginner nutrition timing
- A progress tracking worksheet
- A rest day recovery guide

The only thing left is to start. Pick today as Day 1. Do the first workout. Log it. Then do Day 2 tomorrow.

By Day 30, you'll have completed 20 workouts — and built a habit that lasts far beyond this plan.

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